

New Bern Grand Marina

Website Setup & GitHub Access Guide

This website's code lives in a GitHub repository. This guide walks through everything needed to set up a new computer to make changes to the site — from creating a GitHub account, to getting access to this specific project, to installing the tools, to publishing a change. Keep this guide handy any time a new person needs to help maintain the site, or you're setting things up on a new machine.

Quick Reference

Live website <https://goofyfoot2001.github.io/Marina1/>

GitHub repository <https://github.com/goofyfoot2001/Marina1>

1. Create a GitHub Account

Skip this step if you already have a GitHub account.

1. Go to github.com/join in a web browser.
2. Choose a username, enter your email address, and create a password.
3. Verify your email address when GitHub sends the confirmation link.

2. Get Added as a Collaborator

The website's repository is private to whoever the owner (currently the goofyfoot2001 GitHub account) chooses to add. Anyone else who needs to make changes must be invited first.

The repository owner does this:

1. Sign in to GitHub and open the Marina1 repository.
2. Click Settings (top menu of the repository page).
3. In the left sidebar, click Collaborators and teams.
4. Click Add people, then type the person's GitHub username or the email address they used to sign up.
5. Click Add. GitHub emails that person an invitation.

The new collaborator then needs to open the email (or their GitHub notifications) and accept the invitation before they can access the repository.

3. Install the Tools on the Computer

3a. Install Git

Git is the underlying tool that tracks changes and talks to GitHub. Installing it on Windows also installs Git Credential Manager, which securely remembers your sign-in so you don't have to log in every time.

1. Go to git-scm.com/downloads and download the installer for your operating system.
2. Run the installer and keep the default options unless you have a specific reason to change them.

3b. Install Claude Code

If you'd like Claude's help making changes to the site (instead of editing files and running Git commands by hand), install the Claude Code app.

1. Go to claude.com/claude-code and follow the download/install steps for your computer.
2. Open the app and sign in with your Claude account.

Important: Once the app is open, make sure you are on the Code tab before asking Claude to do anything with files, GitHub, or this website. Working in a different tab was the exact mix-up that caused problems the first time this project was set up — changes and connections made outside the Code tab won't apply the way you expect.

4. Create a Personal Access Token

GitHub no longer accepts your account password when Git connects from a computer. Instead, you create a Personal Access Token (a long, random code) and use that in place of a password the first time you connect.

1. On GitHub, click your profile picture (top right) then Settings.
2. Scroll to the very bottom of the left sidebar and click Developer settings.
3. Click Personal access tokens, then Tokens (classic).
4. Click Generate new token, then Generate new token (classic).
5. Give it a name you'll recognize (e.g. "My Laptop"), set an expiration date, and check the box for repo access.
6. Click Generate token at the bottom.
7. Copy the token immediately — GitHub only shows it to you once.

Treat this token exactly like a password. Never share it with anyone, paste it into a chat message or email, or type it directly into a web address. Early in this project, a token was accidentally saved inside a website address on the computer, which meant anyone who saw that address could see the token — it had to be removed and moved into Git Credential Manager instead, where it's stored securely. If a token is ever exposed, delete it immediately on GitHub (Developer settings, Personal access tokens, Delete) and generate a new one.

5. Connect to the Website's Code

Option A — Using Claude Code

1. Open Claude Code and make sure you're on the Code tab.
2. Tell Claude something like: "Connect to `github.com/goofyfoot2001/Marina1` and set up the website files on this computer."
3. When GitHub asks you to sign in, use the account that was added as a collaborator. If it asks for a password, use the Personal Access Token from Section 4.

Option B — Using Git directly

1. Open a terminal (Command Prompt, PowerShell, or Git Bash).
2. Run the command below to download a copy of the website's code:

```
git clone https://github.com/goofyfoot2001/Marina1.git
```

When prompted, sign in with your GitHub username, and use your Personal Access Token as the password. Git Credential Manager will remember it after that.

6. Making a Change and Publishing It

1. Edit the website files on your computer (directly, or by asking Claude Code to make the change).
2. Save the change to Git:

```
git add .  
git commit -m "describe what changed"
```

Send the change to GitHub:

```
git push
```

Within a minute or two, GitHub Pages automatically rebuilds the live site at `goofyfoot2001.github.io/Marina1` with the new change.

7. Troubleshooting

It keeps asking me to sign in over and over.

Git Credential Manager isn't remembering the token yet. Sign in once more with the token as the password, and it should be saved for next time.

Things aren't working the way Claude describes.

Double-check you're on the Code tab in the Claude app, not a different tab. This exact mix-up caused confusion the first time this project was connected to GitHub.

My push was rejected.

Someone else made changes since you last downloaded a copy. Run "git pull" first, then try "git push" again.

New Bern Grand Marina · Internal reference document · keep this somewhere the whole team can find it.